

711 CE

ARAB-BERBER ARMY INVADES SPAIN

Having conquered North Africa, the forces of the Umayyad caliphate crossed into Visigoth-ruled Spain in 711 CE. This Arab-Berber army led by Tariq ibn Ziyad defeated the Visigothic king Roderic at Guadalete and within six years had overrun the whole of the Iberian peninsula save for small Christian-ruled enclaves in the north.



700 CE

**732 CE The Franks defeat
an Arab army** at Tours,
halting the Islamic empire's
northward advance

725 CE The Hohokam
build settlements with
complex irrigation channels
in Arizona's Sonora Desert



726 CE

ICONOCLASM IN THE BYZANTINE EMPIRE

The veneration of icons (portraits of Christ and the saints) was popular in the Byzantine Empire, but in 726 CE Emperor Leo III instituted a policy of iconoclasm, banning their worship and ordering their destruction. Leo and his senior clerics blamed Byzantine defeats against the Arabs on divine displeasure at icon veneration, and the policy, although unpopular among many ordinary Byzantines, lasted over 60 years.

< Byzantine iconoclasts